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The toast of Little Italy

Centretown woman's life story part of national exhibit

By **CRYSTAL RHYNO**

Centretown resident Maria Ierullo never let inexperience get in the way of her passion or her ambition to make the world a better place; not only for Italian immigrants but for everyone in her community. By becoming one of the first Italian-Canadian women realtors in Ottawa she helped eased the transition to Canada and opened new doors for new immigrants.

In June the Canadian Museum of Civilization will tell many stories like Ierullo's through *Presenza: A new look at Italian-Canadian Heritage*. The exhibit will

run for 15 months featuring exhibits representing the principles, skills and customs that generations of Italian immigrants brought to Canada.

"It's the first national exhibit-

tion on Italian Canadian Heritage. It's quite a major exhibition for us. It focuses on the values and traditions that the immigrant generations brought to Canada and on how these values and traditions are still very relevant to us today," says the museum's senior communications officer Eva Schacherl.

"We have first hand explanations of people on how they relate to the handicrafts, continued practices, values related to work, community life and the spiritual tradition. We hear this through the individual voices," says Schacherl.

Ierullo's own voice will be heard through archival materials including a business calendar, listing agreements, house sale records, and hand-painted cardboard signs in Italian used in the window of her real estate office on Louisa Street.

The lively senior speaks very modestly of her accomplishments and contributions to Centretown. In February she was honoured by the Canadian Women of the Village, for her lifetime of service to the people of Preston Street. And

"[The exhibit] focuses on the values and traditions that the immigrant generations brought to Canada and on how these values and traditions are still very relevant to us today."

"And then to bring out the past and the present, we put this together in sort of little scenes and environments. We really dramatized that encounter between the practices and Canadians of every background and



Honoree Mary Ierullo stands in front of photos of three generations of Ierullo women.

PHOTO PROVIDED

Carleton student named researcher of the year

By LIN MOODY

In early April, downtown resident Emad Gad, a Carleton University Ph.D. electrical engineering student, was presented with the OCRI Futures Award - Student Researcher of the Year by the Ottawa Centre for Research and Innovation (OCRI).

The OCRI Futures Awards recognize the accomplishments of students from the region's post-secondary academic institutions for achievements in leading-edge technology and innovation.

In granting the award, OCRI emphasized the magnitude of Gad's contribution in circuit simulation that "has received international recognition of the highest calibre."

Michel Nakhla, professor and chair of the Department of Electronics at Carleton University is Gad's thesis adviser. He says that Emad can be easily ranked in the top 1% compared to other graduate students and research engineers that he has known.

"He is another example of the amazing calibre of student we are able to attract to Carleton University. During the course of his thesis, he demonstrated an impressive grasp of scientific and technical issues and was

always eager to introduce and try new ideas," says Nakhla. "In my opinion, he is an outstanding, highly innovative researcher."

In 1998, Gad joined Dr. Nakhla's research group at Carleton University which has tackled various unwieldy industrial problems. The group has been published profusely in top-notch international journals and has interacted and collaborated with industry leaders around the world.

Gad says that "working with this group has provided me with enormous opportunities to work on cutting-edge techniques in the simulation and analysis of high-speed and radio frequency circuits. It also offered me an opportunity to present my research work in front of world-class leaders in both research and academia."

Gad's research addresses problems related to the efficiency and accuracy of circuit simulation in computer-aided design (CAD) tools. In the marketplace, there is more and more of a need for fast and accurate CAD tools that enhance designers' abilities to verify and accurately simulate their designs within a short period of time. This ultimately reduces



EMAD GAD

the cost of the design process. Gad has been a teaching assistant with the Department of Electronics at Carleton University since 1998 and a research assistant for the department since 1997.

He has been given an Ontario Graduate Scholarship in Science and Technology for four consecutive years (1999-2001). He has a M.Eng. in Electrical Engineering from Cairo University and a B. Eng. of Electrical Engineering (Honours) from Alexandria University, also in Egypt.

Italian and other backgrounds." A film crew travelled throughout Canada speaking to Italian Canadians and taping interviews, which will be featured throughout the exhibit. Close to 300 artifacts, objects and pictures were loaned and will be used in the exhibit. Items included traditional clothing, works in metal, wood and ceramic, embroidered linens.

other in a long list of recognitions for a deserving ferullo.

"It's such a surprise to me," says the energetic 83-year-old. "I did it because I loved it. I loved the people. I loved their ways. I love the community that has always been growing and look at it now, the way Ottawa is."

The exhibit opens to the public on June 13, 2003.

Redeveloped Flats to be environmentally friendly

By DAVID GLADSTONE

On a quiet Friday afternoon, I met with the NCC's Peter McCourt and Carl Dubé (senior Planner and Flats Project Manager, respectively) in a trailer a stone's throw from the hub of LeBreton Flats, the intersection of Booth Street, the Transitway and the Pathway. I had two closely-connected objectives: to flesh out City Centre Coalition recommendations to the NCC's Board of Directors (which were presented on May 7) aimed at having the Flats consciously re-developed based on sustainable technologies, and to get an on-site briefing on how the re-development of a long-desolate part of our Ward is proceeding.

Before the meeting, I got to wander in what is actually a modern office complex composed of large trailers. There's a receptionist, a large meeting room, and, of course, washrooms, all conveniently located near the LeBreton Transitway Station. McCourt and Dubé happily volunteered that the Transitway is routinely used by NCC staff to travel between their headquarters in the Chambers Building and the Flats, just like Thomas Ahearen travelled a century ago from his Ottawa Electric office on Sparks Street to the then lumber-covered Flats.

This summer will see close to 400 workers on the Flats, who will receive safety briefings and be supplied with convenient wash stations. The three major contractors are Loisel (based in Valleyfield), responsible for the reconstruction of Booth Street Tomlinson, responsible for building the Ottawa River Parkway detour and Quantum Remediation, responsible for taking out the debris-filled berms.

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